

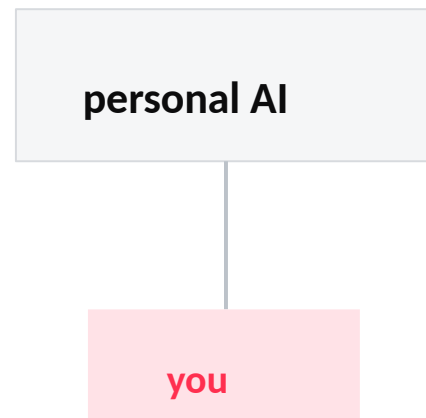
THIEL FELLOWSHIP

Companion

The personal AI that belongs to you.

Advait Paliwal

companion.ai





This has to be built full time now.

The case is simple: personal AI needs two years of uninterrupted building with real people and machines.

- Personal AI only gets good after the same system lives with a person long enough to learn them.
- That loop is shipping, observing, correcting, and redeploying in real lives.
- The Fellowship gives that loop two uninterrupted years.

AI started as distribution. Platform AI became rental.

Original promise

AI as an extension of individual will, broadly distributed, with open research and shared benefits.

Current path

The strongest models are closed, rented, rationed, and revocable by the platforms that run them.

Companion is the fork: intimate AI should be owned by the person it learns.

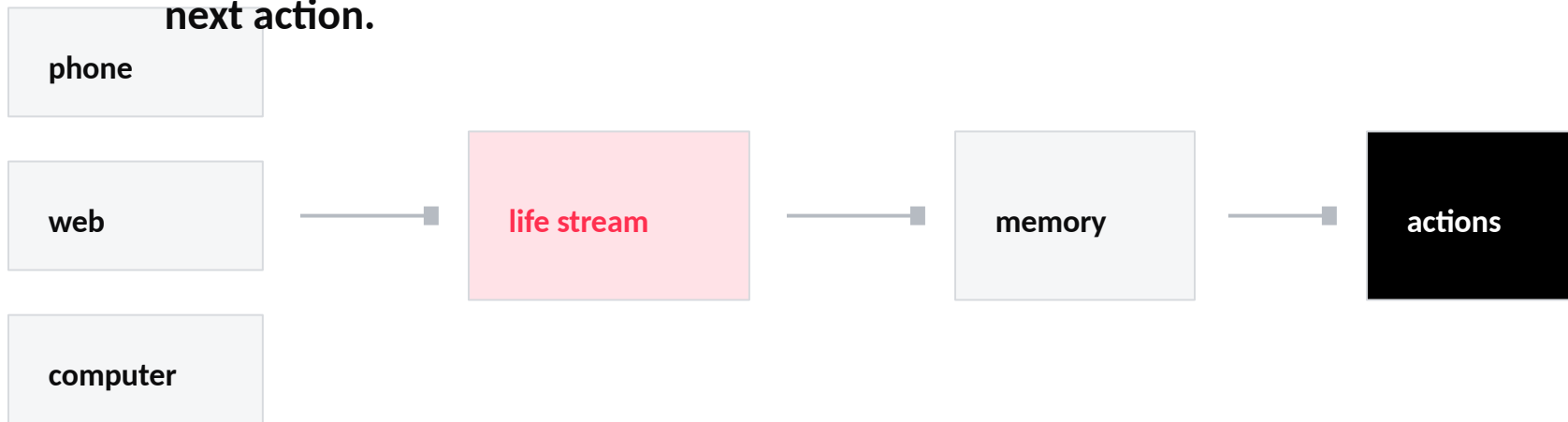
A personal AI has to be owned by the person.

- The valuable data is the person's files, routines, corrections, relationships, and places.
- The model has to remember across years and across product boundaries.
- The person needs the right to keep it, move it, improve it, and run it when a platform changes policy.

Cloud AI is a utility. Personal AI is property.

Companion is the software loop that makes the AI personal.

Every correction, repeated workflow, and ignored suggestion trains the next action.



The first buyers already describe the same machine.

Biotech lab

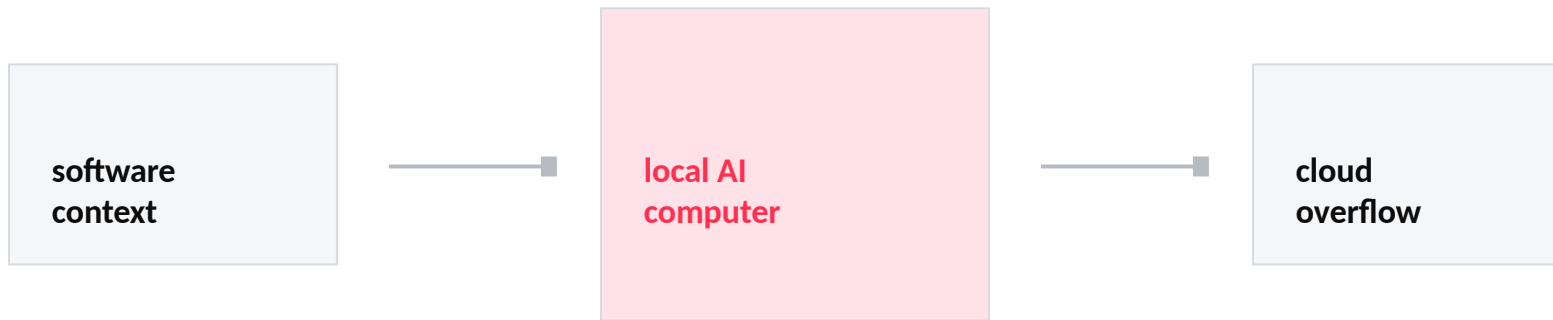
Bought smart speakers and built a rough Signal / SMS / iPad / phone agent. The pull was one AI that understands a bounded technical world.

Small business owner

Asked for cameras, speakers, microphones, and local compute so agents could watch the shop, answer questions, and keep running.

Different places. Same demand: an AI that lives with a world and keeps learning it.

The AI computer is the physical form of that ownership.



Phone, web, local apps, files, rooms, and voice feed one owned machine.
Hard reasoning can burst to cloud while memory stays local.

The hardware wave is real. Companion makes it personal.

270M+

PCs shipped worldwide
in 2025

IDC, 2026

143M

AI PCs forecast for 2026

Gartner, 2025

207B

USD GPU and AI
accelerator spend in
2025

Gartner, 2025

200B

local inference class
on DGX Spark

NVIDIA, 2025

Compute is arriving. The opening is making local compute into a personal product.

Always-on personal agents make renting intelligence break.

rent cloud compute

USD 1.4K-2.2K

per month for a 24/7 personal agent

own the machine

\$27

per month electricity after the computer is paid for

For one person running all day, cloud margin becomes rent.

The moat is compounding context.

- A person's private history compounds with each use.
- Every correction, habit, workflow, file, and place makes the AI harder to replace.
- A smarter generic model can still be worse for the person who trained Companion.
- Ownership makes the most valuable data usable without giving it to a platform.

This becomes a company through a product line.

Brain

USD 2.5K-5K

local AI computer class

Peripherals

USD 99-499

mics, speakers, cameras,
sensors

Support

USD 20-50/mo

updates, backup, cloud
overflow

The point is one consumer system people can buy, own, and keep improving.

I have already built the loops this company needs.

2M+

YouLearn users before
acquisition offer

personal history

8K+

Feynman GitHub stars

open-source proof

6h/day

prior Companion
heavy-user sessions

product pull

MIT

infinite-memory AI
glasses work

technical edge

The founder-market fit is the obsession: memory, local compute, agents, and consumer software have already been my loop.

Two Thiel years produce the first owned personal AI machines.

USD 250K, no equity, two years, and a network of founders, investors, and scientists are exactly the missing inputs.

- Deploy 5 to 10 design partners across lab, small business, and prosumer workflows.
- Ship the local AI computer prototype with phone, web, local apps, and ambient capture.
- Prove memory compounding: the same task improves because Companion learned the person.
- Turn the prototype into the first product people can buy, own, and live with.